

here to watch. And if we're between movie deliveries, there's also Netflix's streaming service. Or, you know, Redbox, whatever floats your boat. Whichever you choose, you're looking at a cost that starts at \$1.75/DVD (they have free movie nights, too) to \$8.99 (Netflix's cheapest tier). Beats the pants off cable.

Need more instant gratification? You can also buy TV episodes one-by-one from iTunes.com for about \$0.99 an episode.

3. Find alternatives to cable for your favorite shows

Now you have the tools you need to figure out if canceling cable would save you money: Write down what shows you watch. Use the Show Finder gadget on CancelCable.com (CancelCable.com/db/ShowFinder.php) to figure out where you can get those shows besides on cable TV. Take the cost per episode on Netflix, iTunes, or whatnot, and multiply it by the number of episodes you watch per month. Is the product less than the cost of your current cable package?

For example, if you pay for cable in order to get HBO shows, you'd have to download a month's worth of "premium" episodes to run up a bill that matches the \$59.99 that

Xfinity starts at for a cable package with HBO.

I'm guessing that almost everyone will feel that cutting cable would save them money, even if they watch a lot. Then it's just a matter of the reception quality. — **Carrie Kirby**

